

Third Term Examination – 2082

Class : XI

Subject: C. English (0031)

Full Marks: 75

Time: 3 hrs.

SET A

Pass Marks: 30

Candidates are required to give their answers in their own words as far as practicable. The figures in the margin indicate full marks.

1. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow.

The digital revolution in music has enabled people to download, store and listen to songs on a tiny, portable device called an MP3 player. But experts say that continuously listening to loud music on these small music players can permanently damage hair cells in the inner ear, resulting in hearing loss. For instance, old-fashioned headphones have been replaced with smaller ones that fit neatly into the ear, instead of over them, which intensifies the sound. In addition to that, digital music does not distort and keeps its crystal-clear sound, even on loud settings, which encourages children to crank up the volume. Combine that with the fact that many children will spend hours listening to their iPods, and you have the recipe for hearing loss. Put into further perspective, most MP3 players can reach levels of 120 decibels, which is louder than a chainsaw or lawnmower. When you consider 85 decibels is the maximum safe decibel level set by hearing experts over the course of a working day, and that children will listen to music at higher decibel levels than that for long periods of time, hearing will invariably suffer.

Apart from hearing damage, there are other serious health risks. We are living in a wireless age. Calls can be made and received on mobiles from anywhere and the internet can be accessed without the need for cables. The advantages are enormous, bringing ease and convenience to our lives. It is clear that mobiles and wireless technology are here to stay but are we paying the price for new technology? Studies have shown that the rapid expansion in the use of wireless technology has brought with it a new form of radiation called ‘electropollution’.

Compared to two generations ago, we are exposed to 100 million times more radiation. The human body consists of trillions of cells which use faint electromagnetic signals to communicate with each other, so that the necessary biological and physiological changes can happen. It is a delicate, natural balance. But this balance is being upset by the constant exposure to electromagnetic radiation (EMR) that we face in our daily lives and it is playing havoc with our bodies. EMR can disrupt and alter the way in which our cells communicate and this can result in abnormal cell behavior. Some studies have shown that exposure to wireless technology can affect our enzyme

production, immune systems, nervous system and even our moods and behavior. The most dangerous part of the phone is around the antenna. This area emits extremely potent radiation which has been shown to cause genetic damage and an increase in the risk of cancer.

Research shows that teenagers and young adults are the largest group of mobile phone users. According to a recent Eurobarometer survey, 70 per cent of Europeans aged 12-13 own a mobile phone and the number of children five to nine years old owning mobiles has greatly increased over the years. It concludes that children are especially vulnerable because their brains and nervous systems are not as immune to attack as adults. Modern technology can have serious mental implications for children that includes severe, addictive behaviour. In one case, two children had to be admitted into a mental health clinic in Northern Spain because of their addiction to mobile phones. An average of six hours a day would be spent talking, texting and playing games on their phones. The children could not be separated from their phones and showed disturbed behaviour that was making them fail at school. They regularly deceived family members to obtain money to buy phone cards to fund their destructive habit. There have been other cases of phone addiction like this.

A. Mark the statements True, False, or Not Given. [5×1=5]

TRUE If the statement agrees with the information given in the text.

FALSE If the statement contradicts the information given in the text.

NOT GIVEN If there is no information in the text.

- a. The modern wireless world offers significant advantages with improved convenience in our lives.
- b. Wireless technology has become an essential part that it is unlikely to disappear in the future.
- c. Continuous exposure to EMR from wireless devices can lead to criminal behaviors.
- d. Excessive use of modern technological devices can lead to obsessive behaviors.
- e. Using technology always helps with academic success.

B. Complete the following sentences using NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the text for each answer. [5×1=5]

- a. Prolonged exposure to loud music can damage irreversibly.
- b. is the highest safe level of sound exposure over 24-hour time.
- c. The human body relies on to allow cells to communicate with one another.
- d. consists the most hazardous part of a cellphone.
- e. Children are at risk because they are not like adults.

- C. Give short answers to the following questions in ONE SENTENCE each.** **[5×1=5]**
- Why do in-ear headphones increase the risk of hearing loss compared to old-fashioned headphones?
 - What are the serious health risks apart from hearing loss caused by wireless technology?
 - Who use mobile phones the most, according to research?
 - What is the conclusion of Eurobarometer survey?
 - What are the serious mental issues caused by prolonged use of technology?
- 2. Write short answers to the following questions in about 75 words each.** **[5×2=10]**
- How did the young maiden die? Could she have survived if she weren't beautiful? (*The Oval Portrait*)
 - Why did the child give a piercing cry at the end? (*The Wish*)
 - Summarize the poem '*Who are you, little i?*'.
 - What is the controlling idea or thesis of the essay '*Sharing Tradition*'? Elucidate.
 - Why do Dona Laura and Don Gonzalo spin fictitious stories about themselves? (*A Sunny Morning*)
- 3. Write long answers to the following questions in about 150 words each.** **[2×5 = 10]**
- What does the author demand for his fellows and society? Why? (*What I Require from Life*)
 - Explain the following lines with reference to the context:
 And so he plays his part. The sixth age shifts
 Into the lean and slippered pantaloons,
 With spectacles on nose and pouch on side;
 His youthful hose, well saved, a world too wide
(*All the World's a Stage*)
- 4. Develop a story from the following clues and give a suitable title:** **[7]**
- A hardworking student – always mocked by classmates – fails once – does not give up – studies day and night – final exam – tops the class – critics surprised – moral about perseverance.
- 5. An old friend from primary school just messaged you out of the blue to say that he/she is moving back to your neighborhood. Write an email expressing your excitement and suggesting a specific place you two should visit to catch up. Focus on using an enthusiastic and welcoming tone.** **[8]**

6. Your school has organized a Science Exhibition showcasing innovative student projects. Draft a press release for local newspapers highlighting the event's objectives, chief guest, and major attractions. [10]

7. Do as directed and rewrite the sentences. [10×1 = 10]

- He met a fantastic teacher yesterday. (Identify the word class of the underlined word.)
- She has arrived..... (at/to/on/by) the location that she was told to. (Choose the correct preposition.)
- One of my students..... (has/have/had) sent me a greeting card recently. (Complete the sentence choosing the correct option from the brackets.)
- I have already decided. I.....help you tomorrow. (Use 'will' or 'am going to'.)
- They got angry when I made a mistake. (Identify whether the underlined verb in this sentence is *transitive*, *intransitive*, or *linking*.)
- We.....wake up early. Otherwise, we may develop severe health problems. (Complete the sentence using 'should' or 'had better'.)
- The person was really helpful. They spoke to him. (Join these sentences using a relative clause.)
- They studied very hard. They could not pass the exam. (Combine these sentences using 'in spite of' or 'despite'.)
- You feel lonely. (Express a wish in the given situation.)
- She(finish) her homework and went to bed. (Use the correct tense of the verbs in the brackets.)

8. Choose and copy the correct option. [5×1 = 5]

- The correct set of guide words for the headword 'innovation' is:
 - inner – innocent
 - invest – invite
 - input – inquiry
 - innocent – input
- The formal plural form of the noun 'cactus' is:
 - cactii
 - cacti
 - cactus
 - cactuses
- Find the word with /z/ sound:
 - books
 - lose
 - loose
 - wash
- The ex-president passed away at his residence. The phrasal verb in this sentence means:
 - died
 - passed a test
 - left the house
 - got awarded
- The word 'swarthy' means:
 - apply a makeup
 - having selfish nature
 - dark skinned
 - attractive personality

☞ - The End - ☞